

Clean Code:

Code is clean if it can be understood easily – by everyone on the team. Clean code can be read and enhanced by a developer other than its original author. With understandability comes readability, changeability, extensibility and maintainability.

General rules

1. Follow standard conventions.

```
class UserProfile:
    def get_user_name(self):
        return "Alice"
```

If you break this and name a class like `user_profile`, it may confuse other developers.

2. Keep it simple stupid. Simpler is always better. Reduce complexity as much as possible.

Bad	Good
<pre>if user.is_logged_in() == True: print("Welcome")</pre>	<pre>if user.is_logged_in(): print("Welcome")</pre>

3. Boy scout rule. Improve the code a little **whenever you touch it** — like cleaning up a campsite. Even small refactors make a big difference over time.
4. Always find the root cause. Always look for the root cause of a problem.

Symptom: Server crashes when uploading large files.

Temporary fix: Block large files.

Root cause: Memory leak in file parser.

Proper fix: Fix the memory leak.

Design rules

1. **Keep configurable data at high levels.**- Configuration (like file paths, timeouts, limits) should reside in top-level components (e.g., config files, environment variables), not hardcoded deep in the codebase.

Bad	Good
<pre>db.connect("localhost", 5432)</pre>	<pre># config.py DB_HOST = "localhost" DB_PORT = 5432 # db_connector.py import config connect_to_db(config.DB_HOST, config.DB_PORT)</pre>

2. **Prefer polymorphism to if/else or switch/case.**

Bad	Good
<pre>if shape.type == "circle": shape.draw_circle() elif shape.type == "square": shape.draw_square()</pre>	<pre>class Shape: def draw(self): pass class Circle(Shape): def draw(self): print("Drawing circle") class Square(Shape): def draw(self): print("Drawing square")</pre>

3. **Separate multi-threading code.**- Isolate multi-threading or concurrency logic from business logic to reduce complexity and improve testability.

4. **Prevent over-configurability.** Avoid exposing too many options that make the system hard to use, test, or maintain. Only make what **needs** to be configurable.

Bad	Good
<pre>config = {"max_connections": 5, "min_connections": 1, "connection_growth_rate": 1.2, ...}</pre>	<pre>config = {"max_connections": 10}</pre>

5. **Use dependency injection.** Inject dependencies rather than creating them internally. This makes code more modular and testable.

Bad	Good
<pre>class Service: def __init__(self):</pre>	<pre>class Service: def __init__(self, db):</pre>

<code>self.db = Database()</code>	<code>self.db = db</code>
-----------------------------------	---------------------------

6. [Follow the Law of Demeter](#). A class should know only its direct dependencies.

Bad	Good
<code>user.get_profile().get_settings().get_theme()</code>	<code>user.get_theme()</code> # Hide the chain of calls inside the user class

Understandability tips

1. [Be consistent](#). Follow consistent naming, structure, and logic across your codebase. It reduces confusion and increases readability.
2. [Use explanatory variable names](#).
3. [Encapsulate boundary conditions](#). Handle edge/boundary conditions in one place so they don't clutter your main logic and are easier to manage or update.

<pre># Encapsulated def is_valid_age(age): return 0 <= age <= 120</pre>

4. [Prefer dedicated value objects to primitive type](#). **Wrap primitive types** (like strings, ints) in objects when they represent specific concepts to give them meaning and behavior.
5. [Avoid logical dependency](#). Don't write methods which works correctly depending on something else in the same class.
6. [Avoid negative conditionals](#).

Bad	Good
<pre>if not is_user_authorized(user): return "Access denied"</pre>	<pre>if is_user_unauthorized(user): return "Access denied"</pre>

Names rules

1. Choose descriptive and unambiguous names.
2. Make meaningful distinctions.
3. Use pronounceable names.
4. Use searchable names.
5. Replace magic numbers with named constants.
6. Avoid encodings. Don't append prefixes or type information.

Functions rules

1. Small.
2. Do one thing.
3. Use descriptive names.
4. Prefer fewer arguments.
5. Have no side effects.

Bad	Good
<pre>total = 0 def add_to_total(x): global total total += x # side effect</pre>	<pre>def add(a, b): return a + b # no side effect</pre>

6. Don't use flag arguments. Split method into several independent methods that can be called from the client without the flag.

Comments rules

1. Always try to explain yourself in code.
2. Don't be redundant.
3. Don't add obvious noise.
4. Don't use closing brace comments.
5. Don't comment out code. Just remove.
6. Use as explanation of intent.
7. Use as clarification of code.
8. Use as a warning of consequences.

Source code structure

1. Separate concepts vertically. Separate **different** ideas with blank lines.
2. Related code should appear vertically dense.
3. Declare variables close to their usage.
4. Dependent functions should be close.
5. Similar functions should be close.

6. Place functions in the downward direction. Functions should be ordered from high-level (more abstract) to low-level (more detailed). This reads like a top-down narrative.

```
def process_order(order):  
    validate(order)  
    charge(order)  
    ship(order)  
  
def validate(order): ...  
def charge(order): ...  
def ship(order): ...
```

7. Keep lines short.
8. Don't use horizontal alignment.
9. Use white space to associate related things and disassociate weakly related.
10. Don't break the indentation.

Tests

1. One assert per test.
2. Readable.
3. Fast.
4. Independent.
5. Repeatable.

Code smells

1. Rigidity. The software is difficult to change. A small change causes a cascade of subsequent changes.
2. Fragility. The software breaks in many places due to a single change.
3. Immobility. You cannot reuse parts of the code in other projects because of involved risks and high effort.
4. Needless Complexity.
5. Needless Repetition.
6. Opacity. The code is hard to understand.